

GOD'S *CONDITIONS*



By Charles Willis

GOD'S CONDITIONS

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Lesson 1 **The Teachings Of Man About Election**

I. Man teaches the supposed fact of unconditional election.

- A. The Confession of Faith of the Presbyterian Church, U.S.A. says, “God from all eternity did by the most wise and holy counsel of his own will, freely and unchangeably ordain whatsoever comes to pass ... By the decree of God, for the manifestation of his glory, some men and angels are predestined unto life, and others foreordained to everlasting death. These angels and men, thus predestinated and foreordained, are particularly and unchangeably designed; and their number is so certain and definite it cannot be either increased or diminished.” (Chap. III)
- B. The Westminster Confession of Faith states, “God has predestined and foreordained some men and angels to everlasting life out of His free grace and love without any foresight of faith or works in man or perseverance in either of them, and others are foreordained to everlasting death and the number of either is so certain and definite that it cannot be increased or diminished.” (Chap. III, art. 3,4 &5; Chap. X, art. 2)
- C. The Baptist Confession of Faith of 1689 says, “Those of mankind who are predestinated unto Life, God, before the foundation of the world was laid, according to His eternal and immutable Purpose, and the secret counsel and good pleasure of His will, hath chosen in Christ to everlasting glory, out of His mere free grace and love, without any other thing in the creature as a condition or cause moving Him thereunto.”

II. What does the Bible say?

- A. How is the word “predestined” used in Scripture? Compare this with the teaching of “unconditional election” (as stated above). Ephesians 1:3–14; Romans 8:28–29

B. 2 Chronicles 19:7; Acts 10:34-35; Romans 2:11; 1 Peter 1:17; 1 Timothy 2:4; 2 Peter 3:9

- C. Discuss how the following verses deny “unconditional election”: Matt. 28:18-20; Matthew 3:7; Matthew 11:28–30.

III. Return to Ephesians 1:3–14 and point to God’s conditions about “election” (who will be saved).

IV. From the following verses, what phrases point to God’s conditions?

- A. Genesis 2:15-17
 - B. 1 John 1:9
 - C. 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18
 - D. James 1:12
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Lesson 2

Conditional Statements About Obedience (Old Testament)

An “If...Then” statement is frequently used in mathematics, and especially computer programming. It is also a strong component of gaining authority in legal documents. We also reason in our everyday life with an “If...Then” logic. Some examples: *If it rains today then I will stay home and read a book. If the price of gasoline is under \$2 then I will fill the tank. If I get off work in time then I will go out to eat with you.* In each of these examples the “If...Then” construction remains even if “then” is omitted. The Bible is full of “If...Then” statements, usually If (man does something) Then (God does something). It is easily understood this is a conditional statement.

In Genesis 18:26 God gives a great If...Then response to Abraham regarding the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah: “*So the Lord said, ‘If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare the whole place on their account.’*” The (If) condition must be met for the (Then) response.

“IF...THEN” For each of the following underline the condition and response. Then give the understood response if the condition is not met.

1. Exodus 19:5 “*Now then, if you will indeed obey My voice and keep My covenant, then you shall be My own possession among all the peoples, for all the earth is Mine*”
2. 2 Chronicles 7:17-18 “*As for you, if you walk before Me as your father David walked, even to do according to all that I have commanded you, and will keep My statutes and My ordinances, 18 then I will establish your royal throne as I covenanted with your father David, saying, ‘You shall not lack a man to be ruler in Israel.’*”
3. Exodus 23:20–22 “*Behold, I am going to send an angel before you to guard you along the way and to bring you into the place which I have prepared. 21 Be on your guard before him and obey his voice; do not be rebellious toward him, for he will not pardon your transgression, since My name is in him. 22 But if you truly obey his voice and do all that I say, then I will be an enemy to your enemies and an adversary to your adversaries.*”
4. Joshua 24:20 “*If you forsake the Lord and serve foreign gods, then He will turn and do you harm and consume you after He has done good to you.*”

MULTIPLE “IF’S” For each of the following underline each condition and response.

5. Jeremiah 7:5–7 “*For if you truly amend your ways and your deeds, if you truly practice justice between a man and his neighbor, 6 if you do not oppress the alien, the orphan, or the widow, and do not shed innocent blood in this place, nor walk after other gods to your own ruin, 7 then I will let you dwell in this place, in the land that I gave to your fathers forever and ever.*”
6. Leviticus 26:3–4, 14–16 “*If you walk in My statutes and keep My commandments so as to carry them out, 4 then I shall give you rains in their season, so that the land will yield its produce and the trees of the field will bear their fruit... ‘But if you do not obey Me and do not carry out all these commandments, 15 if, instead, you reject My statutes, and if your soul abhors My ordinances so as not to carry out all My commandments, and so break My covenant, 16 I, in turn, will do this to you: I will appoint over you a sudden terror, consumption and fever that will waste away the eyes and cause the soul to pine away; also, you will sow your seed uselessly, for your enemies will eat it up.’*”

What would be the response when any one condition is not met?

How does this relate to our understanding of the “plan of salvation” and how a person becomes a Christian?

“IF...BUT” Identify the required response in each passage.

7. Genesis 4:7 *“If you do well, will not your countenance be lifted up? And if you do not do well, sin is crouching at the door; and its desire is for you, but you must master it.”*
8. 1 Chronicles 28:9 *“As for you, my son Solomon, know the God of your father, and serve Him with a whole heart and a willing mind; for the Lord searches all hearts, and understands every intent of the thoughts. If you seek Him, He will let you find Him; but if you forsake Him, He will reject you forever.”*

How should we apply these passages to ourselves as Christians?

MISSING “THEN” For each of the following underline the “response” that would often be indicated by a “then.”

9. Exodus 15:26 *“If you will give earnest heed to the voice of the Lord your God, and do what is right in His sight, and give ear to His commandments, and keep all His statutes, I will put none of the diseases on you which I have put on the Egyptians; for I, the Lord, am your healer.”*
10. 2 Chronicles 6:16 *“Now therefore, O Lord, the God of Israel, keep with Your servant David, my father, that which You have promised him, saying, ‘You shall not lack a man to sit on the throne of Israel, if only your sons take heed to their way, to walk in My law as you have walked before Me.’”*
11. Isaiah 1:18–20 *“Come now, and let us reason together,” Says the Lord, “Though your sins are as scarlet, They will be as white as snow; Though they are red like crimson, They will be like wool. 19 “If you consent and obey, You will eat the best of the land; 20 “But if you refuse and rebel, You will be devoured by the sword.” Truly, the mouth of the Lord has spoken”*
12. Deuteronomy 11:26-28 *“See, I am setting before you today a blessing and a curse: 27 the blessing, if you listen to the commandments of the Lord your God, which I am commanding you today; 28 and the curse, if you do not listen to the commandments of the Lord your God, but turn aside from the way which I am commanding you today, by following other gods which you have not known.”*
13. Deuteronomy 4:29–31 *“But from there you will seek the Lord your God, and you will find Him if you search for Him with all your heart and all your soul. 30 When you are in distress and all these things have come upon you, in the latter days you will return to the Lord your God and listen to His voice. 31 For the Lord your God is a compassionate God; He will not fail you nor destroy you nor forget the covenant with your fathers which He swore to them.”*
14. Deuteronomy 8:19–20 *“It shall come about if you ever forget the Lord your God and go after other gods and serve them and worship them, I testify against you today that you will surely perish. 20 Like the nations that the Lord makes to perish before you, so you shall perish; because you would not listen to the voice of the Lord your God.”*
15. Deuteronomy 30:17–20 *“But if your heart turns away and you will not obey, but are drawn away and worship other gods and serve them, 18 I declare to you today that you shall surely perish. You will not prolong your days in the land where you are crossing the Jordan to enter and possess it.”*

From the passages above give the importance of:

- Obedience To God
- Our Attitude About God’s Commands

Though we live under a difference covenant, why should we expect God to think the same way about us?

- Malachi 3:6
- Psalm 110:25–27
- James 1:17

“IF...THEN” UNDERSTOOD Restate the passage with an “if...then” construction.

16. Jeremiah 29:13 *“You will seek Me and find Me when you search for Me with all your heart.”*

How do we search for God with all our heart?

Conditional Statements

Lesson 3

About Obedience (New Testament)

The Covenant has changed (“we are no longer under a tutor” Galatians 3:25), but God has not: “I, the Lord, do not change” (Malachi 3:6). Just as God has repeatedly and abundantly spoke of the condition of obedience in the Old Testament, that condition remains throughout the New Covenant.

The following passages are conditional statements. Some are a “If...then” statement (or similar construction), some are a “not...but” statement, and some are just a stated condition - all about the need for obedience. **Underline the condition in each of the following passages and answer the related questions.**

1. Matthew 7:21 *“Not everyone who says to Me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ will enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of My Father who is in heaven will enter.”*
 - A. What is the Kingdom of heaven? Point to a Scripture for your answer.
 - B. What is the “will of My Father” in a ‘general’ sense? How does Jesus answer this? (John 6:40, what condition is stated)
 2. Matthew 16:24–26 *“Then Jesus said to His disciples, ‘If anyone wishes to come after Me, he must deny himself, and take up his cross and follow Me. 25 For whoever wishes to save his life will lose it; but whoever loses his life for My sake will find it. 26 For what will it profit a man if he gains the whole world and forfeits his soul? Or what will a man give in exchange for his soul?’”*
 - A. What is meant by we “deny ourselves”? How does this relate to ‘obedience’?
 - B. Explain verse 25.
 3. Matthew 19:17 *“And He said to him, ‘Why are you asking Me about what is good? There is only One who is good; but if you wish to enter into life, keep the commandments.’”*
 - A. How does this compare with the statement: All I have to do is believe, and I will be saved.
 - B. Consider also Acts 16:31 and Romans 10:9 in their contexts.
 4. Luke 6:46 *“Why do you call Me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ and do not do what I say?”*
 5. John 15:4 *“Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit of itself unless it abides in the vine, so neither can you unless you abide in Me.”*
 - A. How do we abide in Christ? (consider also verse 7–10)
 6. John 15:10 *“If you keep My commandments, you will abide in My love; just as I have kept My Father’s commandments and abide in His love.”*
 - A. How did Jesus keep the Father’s commandments? Look at Matthew 3:13-15 and Hebrews 4:15.
 - B. How are we to follow Jesus’ example?
 7. Romans 2:6–10 *“who will render to each person according to his deeds: to those who by perseverance in doing good seek for glory and honor and immortality, eternal life; but to those who are selfishly ambitious and do not obey the truth, but obey unrighteousness, wrath and indignation. There will be tribulation and distress for every soul of man who does evil, of the Jew first and also of the Greek, but glory and honor and peace to everyone who does good, to the Jew first and also to the Greek”*
 - A. Why do we need perseverance in doing good? How does this deny the doctrine ‘once saved, always saved’?
 - B. What is meant by the phrases “doing good” and “obeying unrighteousness”?
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8. Hebrews 10:36 *"For you have need of endurance, so that when you have done the will of God, you may receive what was promised."*
A. Define "endurance" and tell how this relates to doing the will of God.
9. 1 John 1:6–7 *"If we say that we have fellowship with Him and yet walk in the darkness, we lie and do not practice the truth; but if we walk in the Light as He Himself is in the Light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus His Son cleanses us from all sin."*
A. What is meant by "walk in the darkness"?

B. What is meant by "walk in the light"?
10. John 13:17 *"If you know these things, you are blessed if you do them."*
A. What is the implied opposite?
11. 1 John 2:3-6 *"By this we know that we have come to know Him, if we keep His commandments. The one who says, 'I have come to know Him,' and does not keep His commandments, is a liar, and the truth is not in him; but whoever keeps His word, in him the love of God has truly been perfected. By this we know that we are in Him: the one who says he abides in Him ought himself to walk in the same manner as He walked."*
A. What does "know Him" mean?

B. How has the love of God been perfected in us (v.5)?
12. Colossians 1:21–23 *"And although you were formerly alienated and hostile in mind, engaged in evil deeds, yet He has now reconciled you in His fleshly body through death, in order to present you before Him holy and blameless and beyond reproach— if indeed you continue in the faith firmly established and steadfast, and not moved away from the hope of the gospel that you have heard, which was proclaimed in all creation under heaven, and of which I, Paul, was made a minister."*
13. 1 Corinthians 15:12–24. Make a list of all the "if...then" statements. For each statement, restate it in the positive. For example: *"if Christ has not been raised, then our preaching is vain"* (15:14); Christ IS raised, there is usefulness/gain in our preaching.
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Lesson 4

Conditional Warnings

Building on the “if...not”, “if...then” statements, the use of “unless” also indicates a condition. Some simple examples: I will not eat okra unless it is fried. Unless I am called to work, I will be there. I can’t do anything with my son’s hair unless I use lots of hair gel.

Additionally, the use of “or else” (sometimes just “or” and sometimes “if...else”) indicates a condition. This is very common in computer programming, but not limited to that use. An example: You will clean up your room or else I’ll take your things and you won’t see them again.

Underline the condition and circle the warning.

1. 2 Timothy 2:5 *“if anyone competes as an athlete, he does not win the prize unless he competes according to the rules.”*
 - A. What spiritual application should we make from this statement? (See also 1 Corinthians 9:24–27.)

Identify the warning in each reference and answer the questions.

2. John 8:24 *“Therefore I said to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am He, you will die in your sins.”*
 - A. Provide a passage that helps us understand the phrase “die in your sins”?
 - B. The condition of belief is plainly stated. Many think “belief” is all that is necessary to be saved. This demands choosing between the conditions God has stated. Describe how this logic would fail:
 - (A) When using a grocery store coupon.
 - (B) When seeking a mortgage loan.
 - C. Compare this logic with Deuteronomy 10:12; 11:1; 28:1; 1 Kings 6:12
 3. Luke 13:5 *“I tell you, no, but unless you repent, you will all likewise perish.”*
 - A. Define “repent”.
 - B. Compare the passage with Ezekiel 33:11.
 4. Revelation 2:5 *“Therefore remember from where you have fallen, and repent and do the deeds you did at first; or else I am coming to you and will remove your lampstand out of its place—unless you repent.”*
 - A. From the context going back into chapter 1, describe the “place” where the lampstand was to be.
 - B. What does repentance include?
 5. John 3:3 *“Jesus answered and said to him, ‘Truly, truly, I say to you, unless one is born again he cannot see the kingdom of God.’”*
 - A. With Scripture, identify what “born again” means.
 - B. What is the “Kingdom of God”?
 6. John 6:53 *“So Jesus said to them, ‘Truly, truly, I say to you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink His blood, you have no life in yourselves.’”*
 - A. Those in this context hearing Jesus thought this statement was literal. From the continued teaching, explain what Jesus means.
 - B. Emphasize in your explanation the “unless” from verse 53.
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REMINDER (Identify the warning in each reference and answer the questions.)

7. Hebrews 10:38 *"But My righteous one shall live by faith; And if he shrinks back, My soul has no pleasure in him."*
A. Is there a difference in having faith and living by faith?

B. How do we "shrink back"?
8. Exodus 19:22 *"Also let the priests who come near to the Lord consecrate themselves, or else the Lord will break out against them."*
A. How did God "break out against" Israel in the Old Testament?

B. What can we (in the New Covenant) understand from this?
9. Jeremiah 4:4 *"Circumcise yourselves to the Lord And remove the foreskins of your heart, Men of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem, Or else My wrath will go forth like fire And burn with none to quench it, Because of the evil of your deeds."*
A. Compare this with Hebrews 12:4–11. What do we learn about God?

B. Who is a son of disobedience (Ephesians 2:2; 5:6; Colossians 3:6)?
10. Matthew 5:20 *"For I say to you that unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven."*
A. What was deficient in the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees?
11. Matthew 18:3 *"Truly I say to you, unless you are converted and become like children, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven."*
A. Describe the conversion Jesus demands. (see also Matthew 18:4)

Identify the unstated warning in each reference and answer the questions.

12. Romans 10:9 *"if you confess with your mouth Jesus as Lord, and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved"*
13. Matthew 11:28 *"Come to Me, all who are weary and heavy-laden, and I will give you rest."*
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Lesson 5 Conditions Of The Heart And Living

The heart is a very strong theme running throughout Scripture. Deuteronomy 6:5 says *"You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your might."* Jesus said this was the greatest commandment (Matthew 22:37). The heart of stone rejects what God has said. We all need a soft heart to obey God's instructions about how we are to live as a Christian. **Identify the condition in each of the passages in this lesson and answer the questions.**

1. John 15:10 *"If you keep My commandments, you will abide in My love; just as I have kept My Father's commandments and abide in His love."*
 - A. How did Jesus abide in God's love? Try to provide a reference that proves this. A good starting place is 1 John 4:15–21.
 - B. What does it mean to "abide" in His love?
 - C. Compare how Jesus "kept My Father's commandments" and how we try to keep His commandments. Where do we need to improve?
 2. John 8:31 *"So Jesus was saying to those Jews who had believed Him, 'If you continue in My word, then you are truly disciples of Mine'"*
 - A. What is the difference in a "true" disciple and a "false" disciple?
 - B. Define "continue in My word."
 3. Mark 11:26 *"But if you do not forgive, neither will your Father who is in heaven forgive your transgressions."*
Matthew 6:14–15 *"For if you forgive others for their transgressions, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you do not forgive others, then your Father will not forgive your transgressions."*
 - A. Is God's forgiveness conditional?
 - B. Is our forgiveness of others conditional? (Consider Ephesians 4:32, Colossians 3:13; Luke 17:3–4)
 4. Matthew 5:20 *"For I say to you that unless your righteousness surpasses that of the scribes and Pharisees, you will not enter the kingdom of heaven"*
 - A. How was the righteousness of the scribes and Pharisees lacking? (Consider Matthew 23:1–36)
 - B. Give two or three specific ways our righteousness is to surpass the scribes and Pharisees. Try for a supporting passage of Scripture.
 5. Romans 8:28 *"And we know that God causes all things to work together for good to those who love God, to those who are called according to His purpose."*
 - A. Explain "called according to His purpose".
 - B. What should be in our heart when everything in this life seems to fall apart and turns terrible?
 6. James 4:10 *"Humble yourselves in the presence of the Lord, and He will exalt you."* (Examine the context of 4:4–10).
 - A. How do we humble ourselves? What is this telling us to do?
 - B. Is the "exalting" of God in this life or the life to come?
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7. 1 John 4:12 *"No one has seen God at any time; if we love one another, God abides in us, and His love is perfected in us."*
1 John 4:20 *"If someone says, 'I love God,' and hates his brother, he is a liar; for the one who does not love his brother whom he has seen, cannot love God whom he has not seen."*
- A. Describe the love we are to have for one another.
 - B. Which do most people think about more: how I show love to others, or how others show love to me?
8. Galatians 6:9 *"Let us not lose heart in doing good, for in due time we will reap if we do not grow weary."*
(also stated in 2 Thessalonians 3:13).
- A. How or why do we grow weary of doing good?
 - B. Look at Hebrews 12:3 and Revelation 2:3.
 - C. What are we supposed to be doing? (1 Thessalonians 5:11, 14 and Romans 14:19)
9. James 1:12 *"Blessed is a man who perseveres under trial; for once he has been approved, he will receive the crown of life which the Lord has promised to those who love Him."*
- A. How is this man "approved"?
 - B. What is the connection between love for God and perseverance?
10. Matthew 10:22 *"You will be hated by all because of My name, but it is the one who has endured to the end who will be saved."*
- A. What is implied with the word "endured"?
 - B. What is meant by "endured" in Revelation 2:10–11?
 - C. What does Matthew 10:34–39 teach us about our endurance?
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Lesson 6

Conditions About Salvation

If you ask five people about how to be saved, you will very likely get different answers. If you ask five people what the Bible says about how to be saved, you will still likely get different answers. Many false teachings exist and are prevalent in our society, to the extent people really do not know what the Bible says. If someone believes the Bible is God's Word, then examining things in this lesson will be helpful to them.

Identify conditions in any of the passages in this lesson (not all will have a conditional statement) and answer the questions.

1. Hear

- A. John 6:44–45 *"No one can come to Me unless the Father who sent Me draws him; and I will raise him up on the last day. It is written in the prophets, 'And they shall all be taught of God.' Everyone who has heard and learned from the Father, comes to Me."*
- B. Romans 10:17 *"So faith comes from hearing, and hearing by the word of Christ"*
- C. Romans 1:16 *"For I am not ashamed of the gospel, for it is the power of God for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek."*
- D. 1 Peter 1:23–25 *"for you have been born again not of seed which is perishable but imperishable, that is, through the living and enduring word of God. For, 'All flesh is like grass, And all its glory like the flower of grass. The grass withers, And the flower falls off, But the word of the Lord endures forever.'" And this is the word which was preached to you."*
- E. How is the word of Christ and the word of God (the gospel) a condition for salvation?

2. Believe

- A. John 3:16 *"For God so loved the world, that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him shall not perish, but have eternal life."*
 - B. Hebrews 11:6 *"And without faith it is impossible to please Him, for he who comes to God must believe that He is and that He is a rewarder of those who seek Him"*
 - C. John 8:24 *"Therefore I said to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am He, you will die in your sins."*
 - D. James 2:17 *"Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead, being by itself"*
 - E. Galatians 5:6 *"For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision nor uncircumcision means anything, but faith working through love"*
 - F. Acts 16:31–34 *"They said, 'Believe in the Lord Jesus, and you will be saved, you and your household. And they spoke the word of the Lord to him together with all who were in his house. 33 And he took them that very hour of the night and washed their wounds, and immediately he was baptized, he and all his household. 34 And he brought them into his house and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, having believed in God with his whole household.'"*
 - G. Is belief a condition for salvation?
 - H. What must be believed?
 - I. Describe the relationship between faith and works.
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3. Repent

- A. Luke 13:3 *"I tell you, no, but unless you repent, you will all likewise perish."*
- B. 2 Peter 3:9 *"The Lord is not slow about His promise, as some count slowness, but is patient toward you, not wishing for any to perish but for all to come to repentance."*
- C. Acts 17:30 *"Therefore having overlooked the times of ignorance, God is now declaring to men that all people everywhere should repent"*
- D. Acts 3:19 *"Therefore repent and return, so that your sins may be wiped away, in order that times of refreshing may come from the presence of the Lord"*
- E. What is repentance?
- F. How does this compare with #6 in this lesson (live faithfully)? What is the difference?

4. Confess

- A. Romans 10:9–10 *"if you confess with your mouth Jesus as Lord, and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved; for with the heart a person believes, resulting in righteousness, and with the mouth he confesses, resulting in salvation"*
- B. Matthew 10:32–33 *"Therefore everyone who confesses Me before men, I will also confess him before My Father who is in heaven. But whoever denies Me before men, I will also deny him before My Father who is in heaven."*
- C. 1 John 4:15 *"Whoever confesses that Jesus is the Son of God, God abides in him, and he in God."*
- D. What are we saying when we confess *"Jesus as Lord"*?
- E. How is this a condition of salvation?

5. Be Baptized

- A. 1 Peter 3:21 *"Corresponding to that, baptism now saves you—not the removal of dirt from the flesh, but an appeal to God for a good conscience—through the resurrection of Jesus Christ"*
- B. Mark 16:16 *"He who has believed and has been baptized shall be saved; but he who has disbelieved shall be condemned."*
- C. Acts 2:38 *"Peter said to them, 'Repent, and each of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of your sins; and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.'"*
- D. Romans 6:3–7 *"Or do you not know that all of us who have been baptized into Christ Jesus have been baptized into His death? Therefore we have been buried with Him through baptism into death, so that as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, so we too might walk in newness of life. For if we have become united with Him in the likeness of His death, certainly we shall also be in the likeness of His resurrection, knowing this, that our old self was crucified with Him, in order that our body of sin might be done away with, so that we would no longer be slaves to sin; for he who has died is freed from sin."*
- E. In these references what helps us understand what baptism is (sprinkling, pouring, immersion)?
- F. How is baptism a condition of salvation?
- G. From Romans 6 (above), how does the first sentence and the last phrase relate? How does this point to a "condition"?

6. Live Faithfully

- A. Hebrews 5:9 *"And having been made perfect, He became to all those who obey Him the source of eternal salvation"*
- B. Acts 10:34–35 *"I most certainly understand now that God is not one to show partiality, but in every nation the man who fears Him and does what is right is welcome to Him"*
- C. Matthew 7:21 *"Not everyone who says to Me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of My Father who is in heaven will enter."*
- D. John 14:15 *"If you love Me, you will keep My commandments."* 1 John 5:3 *"For this is the love of God, that we keep His commandments; and His commandments are not burdensome"*
- E. Restate these passages as a warning as if the stated condition is not met.

7. In Christ

- A. 2 Corinthians 5:17 *"Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creature; the old things passed away; behold, new things have come."*
- B. Galatians 3:27 *"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ"*
- C. Romans 6:3 *"Or do you not know that all of us who have been baptized into Christ Jesus have been baptized into His death?"*
- D. Ephesians 1:3–14 *"Blessed be the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly places in Christ, 4 just as He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world, that we would be holy and blameless before Him. In love 5 He predestined us to adoption as sons through Jesus Christ to Himself, according to the kind intention of His will, 6 to the praise of the glory of His grace, which He freely bestowed on us in the Beloved. 7 In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace 8 which He lavished on us. In all wisdom and insight 9 He made known to us the mystery of His will, according to His kind intention which He purposed in Him 10 with a view to an administration suitable to the fullness of the times, that is, the summing up of all things in Christ, things in the heavens and things on the earth. In Him 11 also we have obtained an inheritance, having been predestined according to His purpose who works all things after the counsel of His will, 12 to the end that we who were the first to hope in Christ would be to the praise of His glory. 13 In Him, you also, after listening to the message of truth, the gospel of your salvation—having also believed, you were sealed in Him with the Holy Spirit of promise, 14 who is given as a pledge of our inheritance, with a view to the redemption of God's own possession, to the praise of His glory."*
- E. What does it mean to be "in Christ"? How do we get into Christ? What is the benefit of studying this with a friend?

8. Saved by Grace (not a condition of our salvation, but a gift)

- A. Titus 2:11 *"For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to all men"*
 - B. Romans 3:24 *"being justified as a gift by His grace through the redemption which is in Christ Jesus"*
 - C. Ephesians 2:8–9 *"For by grace you have been saved through faith; and that not of yourselves, it is the gift of God; not as a result of works, so that no one may boast."*
 - D. 2 Timothy 1:9 *"who has saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works, but according to His own purpose and grace which was granted us in Christ Jesus from all eternity"*
 - E. Ephesians 1:7 *"In Him we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of our trespasses, according to the riches of His grace"*
 - F. Does God's grace negate all of His conditions for our salvation? Please explain.
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Lesson 7

Conditions About Prayer

Prayer is a basic fundamental of faith in God. People pray in a lot of different ways, and some are surprised to see things God has said about prayer: even some conditions regarding prayer. This lesson will examine several of those conditions, but also some general principles about prayer.

Identify conditions in any of the passages in this lesson (not all will have a conditional statement) and answer the questions.

1. 1 Timothy 2:5 *"For there is one God, and one mediator also between God and men, the man Christ Jesus."* 1 John 2:1 *"And if anyone sins, we have an Advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous."*
 - A. Who are we praying to?
 - B. What is Jesus' role?

Colossians 3:17 *"Whatever you do in word or deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks through Him to God the Father."*

Hebrews 4:14–16 *"Therefore, since we have a great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. For we do not have a high priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but One who has been tempted in all things as we are, yet without sin. Therefore let us draw near with confidence to the throne of grace, so that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in time of need."*
 - C. How is this truth a "condition" of prayer?
 2. 1 Peter 3:12 *"For the eyes of the Lord are toward the righteous, And His ears attend to their prayer, But the face of the Lord is against those who do evil."*
 - A. How is this truth stated in Psalm 66:17–20 *"I cried to Him with my mouth, And He was extolled with my tongue. If I regard wickedness in my heart, The Lord will not hear; But certainly God has heard; has given heed to the voice of my prayer. Blessed be God, Who has not turned away my prayer Nor His lovingkindness from me."*
 - B. Compare this with Acts 20:31 *"Cornelius, your prayer has been heard and your alms have been remembered before God."*
 - C. What about Christians who continue in sin?
 3. James 1:5–8 *"But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask of God, who gives to all generously and without reproach, and it will be given to him. But he must ask in faith without any doubting, for the one who doubts is like the surf of the sea, driven and tossed by the wind. For that man ought not to expect that he will receive anything from the Lord, being a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways."*
 - A. How would this man be "double-minded"?
 - B. How did God respond to Solomon's prayer for wisdom? (1 Kings 3:5–14)
 - C. Consider also Proverbs 4:5–7 and 9:10.
 4. John 15:7 *"If you abide in Me, and My words abide in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be done for you."*
 - A. How do we abide in Christ? How do His words abide in us?
 - B. Consider also what Jesus said to the apostles in Matthew 21:22 *"And all things you ask in prayer, believing, you will receive."*
 5. 1 John 5:14 *"This is the confidence which we have before Him, that, if we ask anything according to His will, He hears us."*
 - A. Provide an example of praying something "according to His will" and of something "not according to His will."
 - B. How can we know the difference?
 - C. What do we learn from these examples?

Matthew 26:39 *"He went a little beyond them, and fell on His face and prayed, saying, 'My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from Me; yet not as I will, but as You will.'"*

James 4:2–3 *"You lust and do not have; so you commit murder. You are envious and cannot obtain; so you fight and quarrel. You do not have because you do not ask. You ask and do not receive, because you ask with wrong motives, so that you may spend it your pleasures."*
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6. Philippians 4:6–7 *“Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all comprehension, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus.”*
- A. How does this relate to Luke 18:1 *“Now He was telling them a parable to show that at all times they ought to pray and not to lose heart”*
- B. How can the peace of God guard our hearts and minds? Matthew 26:41 *“Keep watching and praying that you may not enter into temptation; the spirit is willing, but the flesh is weak.”* Luke 22:40 *“Pray that you may not enter into temptation.”*
- C. Consider the parable of the persistent widow (Luke 18:1–8).
7. Matthew 6:5–7 *“When you pray, you are not to be like the hypocrites; for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and on the street corners so that they may be seen by men. Truly I say to you, they have their reward in full. But you, when you pray, go into your inner room, close your door and pray to your Father who is in secret, and your Father who sees what is done in secret will reward you.”* And when you are praying, do not use meaningless repetition as the Gentiles do, for they suppose that they will be heard for their many words. So do not be like them; for your Father knows what you need before you ask Him.”
- A. What makes a repetition meaningless? (King James says “vain”)
- B. What then should our heart be like when we do pray in public (in an assembly, or over a meal)?
8. 1 Timothy 2:8 *“Therefore I want the men in every place to pray, lifting up holy hands, without wrath and dissension”*
- A. How would wrath and dissension make our hands unholy?
9. James 5:13–16 *“Is anyone among you suffering? Then he must pray. Is anyone cheerful? He is to sing praises. Is anyone among you sick? Then he must call for the elders of the church and they are to pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord; and the prayer offered in faith will restore the one who is sick, and the Lord will raise him up, and if he has committed sins, they will be forgiven him. Therefore, confess your sins to one another, and pray for one another so that you may be healed. The effective prayer of a righteous man can accomplish much.”*
- A. Try to provide one or two examples in Scripture of praying for one another.
- B. What effective prayer of a righteous man is given in the next few verses of James 5?
10. Colossians 4:2 *“Devote yourselves to prayer, keeping alert in it with an attitude of thanksgiving”*
- A. What does it mean to be devoted to prayer?
- B. Why the instruction “keeping alert in it”?
11. Acts 8:22 *“repent of this wickedness of yours, and pray the Lord that, if possible, the intention of your heart may be forgiven you.”*
- A. Apply some thoughts from previous passages in this lesson about what our attitude should be when praying for forgiveness.
- B. Did Simon commit a sin, or sin in his heart? When should we seek forgiveness? Compare also with Matthew 5:28.
12. 1 Peter 3:7 *“You husbands in the same way, live with your wives in an understanding way, as with someone weaker, since she is a woman; and show her honor as a fellow heir of the grace of life, so that your prayers will not be hindered.”*
- A. What would hinder our prayers? (Give an answer regarding marriage, and an answer not regarding marriage)
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Lesson 8

Conditions About Falling Away

Scripture is very clear that some “will fall away from the faith” (1 Timothy 4:1). We are warned in Hebrews 3:12 “Take care, brethren, that there not be in any one of you an evil, unbelieving heart that falls away from the living God.” Once we have tasted “the good word of God and the powers of the age to come, and then have fallen away, it is impossible to renew them again to repentance” (Hebrews 6:5–6). This is a horrible state which some Christians choose. They have obeyed the gospel, but then turn back to the world and turn their back on God.

In the following passages, underline the condition and answer the questions.

1. Galatians 6:9 *“Let us not lose heart in doing good, for in due time we will reap if we do not grow weary.”*
 - A. Explain the connection between ‘not losing heart in doing good’, and ‘not growing weary’.
 - B. Provide two examples from your experiences of how we lose heart in doing good.
 - C. How do we keep from growing weary? How important is this?
 2. Colossians 1:22–23 *“yet He has now reconciled you in His fleshly body through death, in order to present you before Him holy and blameless and beyond reproach— if indeed you continue in the faith firmly established and steadfast, and not moved away from the hope of the gospel that you have heard, which was proclaimed in all creation under heaven, and of which I, Paul, was made a minister.”*
 - A. What does this passage say is ‘God’s part’ and ‘my part’ in being presented to God as holy and blameless?
 - B. What does “firmly established” (NASB), “grounded” (KJ) mean?
 - C. What importance does God place on our steadfastness? How do we improve our steadfastness?
 3. John 8:31 *“So Jesus was saying to those Jews who had believed Him, “If you continue in My word, then you are truly disciples of Mine”*
 - A. Is belief all that is needed to be saved?
 - B. How does continuing in the word indicate we are a true disciple?
 - C. 1 Corinthians 15:2 *“by which also you are saved, if you hold fast the word which I preached to you, unless you believed in vain.”*
 1. Is there a difference in ‘continuing in Jesus word’ and ‘hold fast the word which Paul preached’?
 2. How can belief be vain?
 4. Hebrews 3:6, 14 *“but Christ was faithful as a Son over His house—whose house we are, if we hold fast our confidence and the boast of our hope firm until the end” ... “For we have become partakers of Christ, if we hold fast the beginning of our assurance firm until the end”* (1 Corinthians 15:2)
 - A. What are we holding fast to?
 - B. What if our confidence is not firm?
 - C. How do we regain our confidence?
 5. Romans 11:21–22 *“for if God did not spare the natural branches, He will not spare you, either. Behold then the kindness and severity of God; to those who fell, severity, but to you, God’s kindness, if you continue in His kindness; otherwise you also will be cut off.”*
 - A. From the earlier context of chapter 11, what natural branches were cut off? What was “grafted in” (v.17)?
 - B. How do we continue in “His kindness”?
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6. Romans 8:13 *"for if you are living according to the flesh, you must die; but if by the Spirit you are putting to death the deeds of the body, you will live."*
- A. It matters how we live after being baptized into Christ. Give the meaning of living "by the Spirit"?
(see also Galatians 5:25).
 - B. How do we "put to death the deeds of the body"?
(See also Colossians 3:5–6 and Galatians 5:19–21)
7. Hebrews 10:26–31 *"For if we go on sinning willfully after receiving the knowledge of the truth, there no longer remains a sacrifice for sins, but a terrifying expectation of judgment and the fury of a fire which will consume the adversaries. Anyone who has set aside the Law of Moses dies without mercy on the testimony of two or three witnesses. How much severer punishment do you think he will deserve who has trampled under foot the Son of God, and has regarded as unclean the blood of the covenant by which he was sanctified, and has insulted the Spirit of grace? For we know Him who said, "Vengeance is Mine, I will repay." And again, "The Lord will judge His people." It is a terrifying thing to fall into the hands of the living God"*
- A. Why would there ever be no sacrifice for sin? Explain the meaning.
 - B. Who is an "adversary" of God (v.27)?
 - C. Is God vengeful and terrifying, or is God love? (see again question #5)
8. Hebrews 10:36–39 *"For you have need of endurance, so that when you have done the will of God, you may receive what was promised. For yet in a very little while, He who is coming will come, and will not delay. But My righteous one shall live by faith; And if he shrinks back, My soul has no pleasure in him. But we are not of those who shrink back to destruction, but of those who have faith to the preserving of the soul."*
- A. How do we shrink back?
 - B. How do we gain endurance?
 - C. Is being a Christian about knowing the will of God or doing the will of God?
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Lesson 9

Conditional Requirements

This lesson will include many examples of “conditional language” which we have examined in prior lessons. This lesson will also look at additional examples of: “must”, “must not”, “except”, “as long as”, and “only if.” Generally, this lesson will examine passages where we see requirements of God that must be met for us to have authority to act or do. **For each reference please underline the condition(s) and answer the questions.**

1. 1 Timothy 3:1–7 *“It is a trustworthy statement: if any man aspires to the office of overseer, it is a fine work he desires to do. 2 An overseer, then, must be above reproach, the husband of one wife, temperate, prudent, respectable, hospitable, able to teach, 3 not addicted to wine or pugnacious, but gentle, peaceable, free from the love of money. 4 He must be one who manages his own household well, keeping his children under control with all dignity 5 (but if a man does not know how to manage his own household, how will he take care of the church of God?), 6 and not a new convert, so that he will not become conceited and fall into the condemnation incurred by the devil. 7 And he must have a good reputation with those outside the church, so that he will not fall into reproach and the snare of the devil.”*
 - A. For three of the conditions stated in this reference, please provide an “opposite” or “something else” that is understood to be without authority.
 - B. Is the word “must” (in verse 2) applicable to every trait in verses 2–3? Compare this to the use of “must” in James 1:19.
2. Titus 1:5–9 *“For this reason I left you in Crete, that you would set in order what remains and appoint elders in every city as I directed you, 6 namely, if any man is above reproach, the husband of one wife, having children who believe, not accused of dissipation or rebellion. 7 For the overseer must be above reproach as God’s steward, not self-willed, not quick-tempered, not addicted to wine, not pugnacious, not fond of sordid gain, 8 but hospitable, loving what is good, sensible, just, devout, self-controlled, 9 holding fast the faithful word which is in accordance with the teaching, so that he will be able both to exhort in sound doctrine and to refute those who contradict.”*
 - A. Explain the condition “in accordance with the teaching” (v. 9).
 - B. What is part of the responsibility of an elder (verses 9–11)? How important is this for the congregation?
3. 1 Timothy 3:8–12 *“Deacons likewise must be men of dignity, not double-tongued, or addicted to much wine or fond of sordid gain, 9 but holding to the mystery of the faith with a clear conscience. 10 These men must also first be tested; then let them serve as deacons if they are beyond reproach. 11 Women must likewise be dignified, not malicious gossips, but temperate, faithful in all things. 12 Deacons must be husbands of only one wife, and good managers of their children and their own households.”*
 - A. Explain if deacons are supposed to be men (v.8) or women (v.11).
 - B. From the references in questions 1–3, what qualification generally allows for a younger man to serve as a Deacon, but would disqualify him from serving as a Elder?
 - C. Explain the qualification “must also first be tested” (v.10).

4. 1 Timothy 5:1–10 *“Honor widows who are widows indeed; 4 but if any widow has children or grandchildren, they must first learn to practice piety in regard to their own family and to make some return to their parents; for this is acceptable in the sight of God. 5 Now she who is a widow indeed and who has been left alone, has fixed her hope on God and continues in entreaties and prayers night and day. 6 But she who gives herself to wanton pleasure is dead even while she lives. 7 Prescribe these things as well, so that they may be above reproach. 8 But if anyone does not provide for his own, and especially for those of his household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever. 9 A widow is to be put on the list only if she is not less than sixty years old, having been the wife of one man, 10 having a reputation for good works; and if she has brought up children, if she has shown hospitality to strangers, if she has washed the saints’ feet, if she has assisted those in distress, and if she has devoted herself to every good work.”*

A. How do we “honor” widows who are widows indeed?

B. How does “every” become a conditional aspect in verse 10?

C. What is “wanton pleasure” (verse 6) and why would this make her “dead”?

5. Matthew 5:31–32 *“It was said, ‘Whoever sends his wife away, let him give her a certificate of divorce’; 32 but I say to you that everyone who divorces his wife, except for the reason of unchastity, makes her commit adultery; and whoever marries a divorced woman commits adultery.”*

A. What conditional statement allows a divorced person to remarry and it not be adultery?

B. What conditions in this passage would make a person ineligible for a “Scriptural” marriage?

6. 1 Corinthians 7:10–11 *“But to the married I give instructions, not I, but the Lord, that the wife should not leave her husband 11 (but if she does leave, she must remain unmarried, or else be reconciled to her husband), and that the husband should not divorce his wife.”*

A. Is “leaving” (verse 10) the same as “divorce” (verse 11)? Hint: a conditional phrase will answer this.

B. When should a person learn the truths in Matthew 5 and 1 Corinthians 7?

7. Acts 1:21–22 *“Therefore it is necessary that of the men who have accompanied us all the time that the Lord Jesus went in and out among us— 22 beginning with the baptism of John until the day that He was taken up from us—one of these must become a witness with us of His resurrection.”*

A. Who is qualified today to be an apostle?

END OF STUDY - Final Questions

- Are you now seeing more “conditions” as you read through Scripture? How does this impact your understanding?
 - How does a condition stress the importance of something?
 - Who has the authority to place a condition on anything religious?
 - Think back to lesson #1. Does the concept of “unconditional election” sound more absurd now than when you started this series?
 - Who might you wish to study this material with?
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